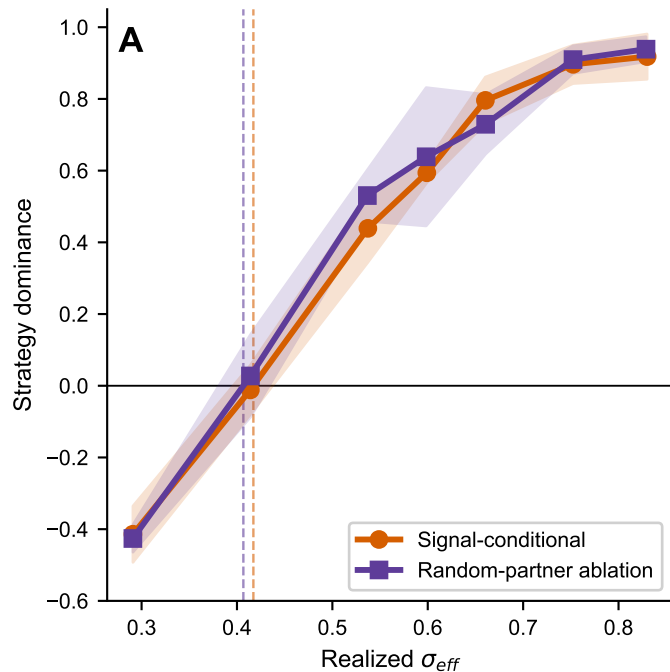
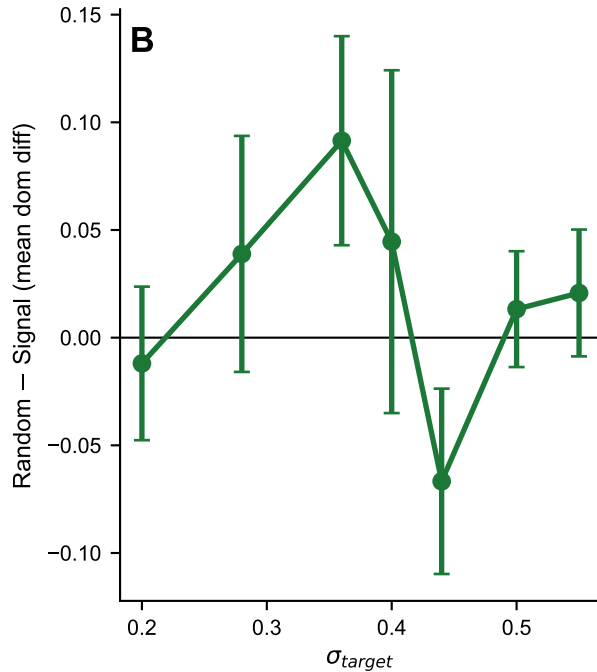


Phase transition: signal vs random-partner ablation
crossover at $\sigma_{eff}^* \approx 0.417$ (signal) vs ≈ 0.407 (random)



Threshold shift between modes
(differences within replicate noise)



Side-by-side dominance comparison
(saturation arms match exactly)

